



Presented by The High End



CASTLE FORTRESS ALPHA

Full-Size Cardboard Castle with Towers, Battlements & Gatehouse

Build a real castle. With towers. And battlements. And an arch you walk through.

AGES
4–12

BOXES
5–7 Large Boxes

TIME
3–4 Hours

DIFF
Advanced ***

PIECES
5 pcs

CARDBOARD NEEDED:

5–7 Large Boxes (at least 24" × 36" (61 × 91 cm) each)

MISSION GOAL:

Build a castle: walk-through gatehouse arch, 2 gatehouse towers, 2 corner towers, side walls, crenellated battlements on all surfaces.

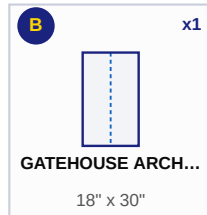
1

STEP 1: BUILD THE GATEHOUSE ARCH

Take the Gatehouse Arch Panel. Using the (arch) arch mark on the template, cut a large arch opening in the center. The arch must be tall enough for a child to walk through comfortably. Keep solid cardboard frame on all sides of the arch.

SAFETY: Adult cuts the arch only. Smooth curved top — no jagged edges inside the arch.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP



! ADULT ASSIST NEEDED



BUILD TO MATCH THIS

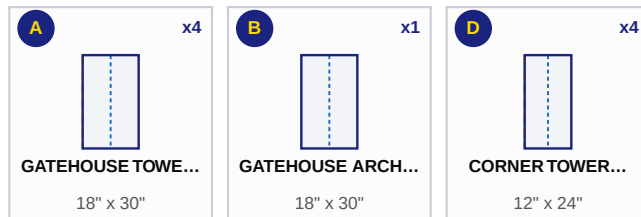
2

STEP 2: BUILD THE TWO GATEHOUSE TOWERS

For each tower: take 2 Tower Panels and tape them at a 90° corner (corner edge mark on template). The tower L-shapes attach to each side of the arch panel. Towers must be taller than the arch center.

SAFETY: Two people needed to hold tower panels at 90° while taping the corner.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP



! ADULT ASSIST NEEDED

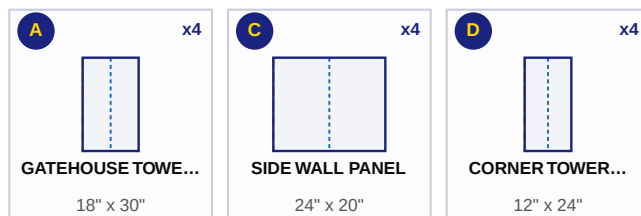
3

STEP 3: CUT CRENELLATIONS

Use the notch marks on the template as your guide. Cut alternating rectangular notches across the tops of ALL tower panels and wall panels — each notch 4" (10 cm) wide x 3" (8 cm) tall. These are the battlements. Every surface gets them.

SAFETY: Adult cuts notches on all pieces. Mark all notches with pencil first.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP



! ADULT ASSIST NEEDED

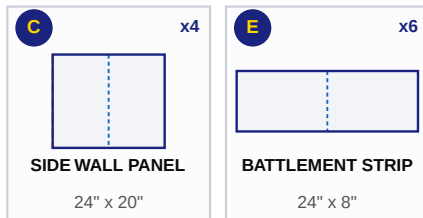
! ADULT ASSIST NEEDED

4

STEP 4: ADD SIDE WALLS

Tape 2 Side Wall Panels to each side of the gatehouse structure (inner edge marks). Walls extend outward from the towers and are lower than the towers. Add battlement strips along all wall tops.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP

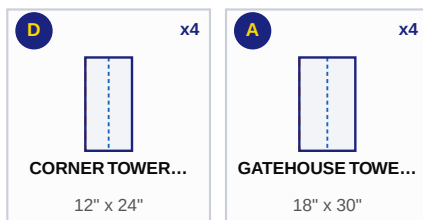


5

STEP 5: BUILD CORNER TOWERS

At the far ends of both side walls, build 2 corner towers using 2 Corner Tower Panels each (same 90° L-shape, corner edge marks). Smaller than the gatehouse towers. Add battlement notches on top.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP



6

STEP 6: DRAW THE STONE PATTERN

THIS IS THE MOST IMPORTANT STEP. On ALL surfaces: draw horizontal lines every 2 inches. Then add short vertical lines offset from row to row — staggered brick pattern. Every wall, tower, and battlement. Do not skip any surface.

7

STEP 7: PAINT GREY

Paint all surfaces medium grey. Slightly vary shade in some areas for depth. The stone pattern under the grey is what makes it look real.

8

STEP 8: MOSS DETAILS

At the base of every wall and tower, add mossy green paint 2–3" (5–8 cm) up from the bottom. Real castle walls always have moss at the base.

9

STEP 9: QUALITY CHECK

Stand back and compare to cover photo. Arch walkable. Towers on both sides. Side walls extend outward. Corner towers at ends. Battlements on everything. Stone pattern. Grey paint. Matches the photo.

QUALITY CHECK!

Does your build match the cover photo? Compare side by side before you call it done.

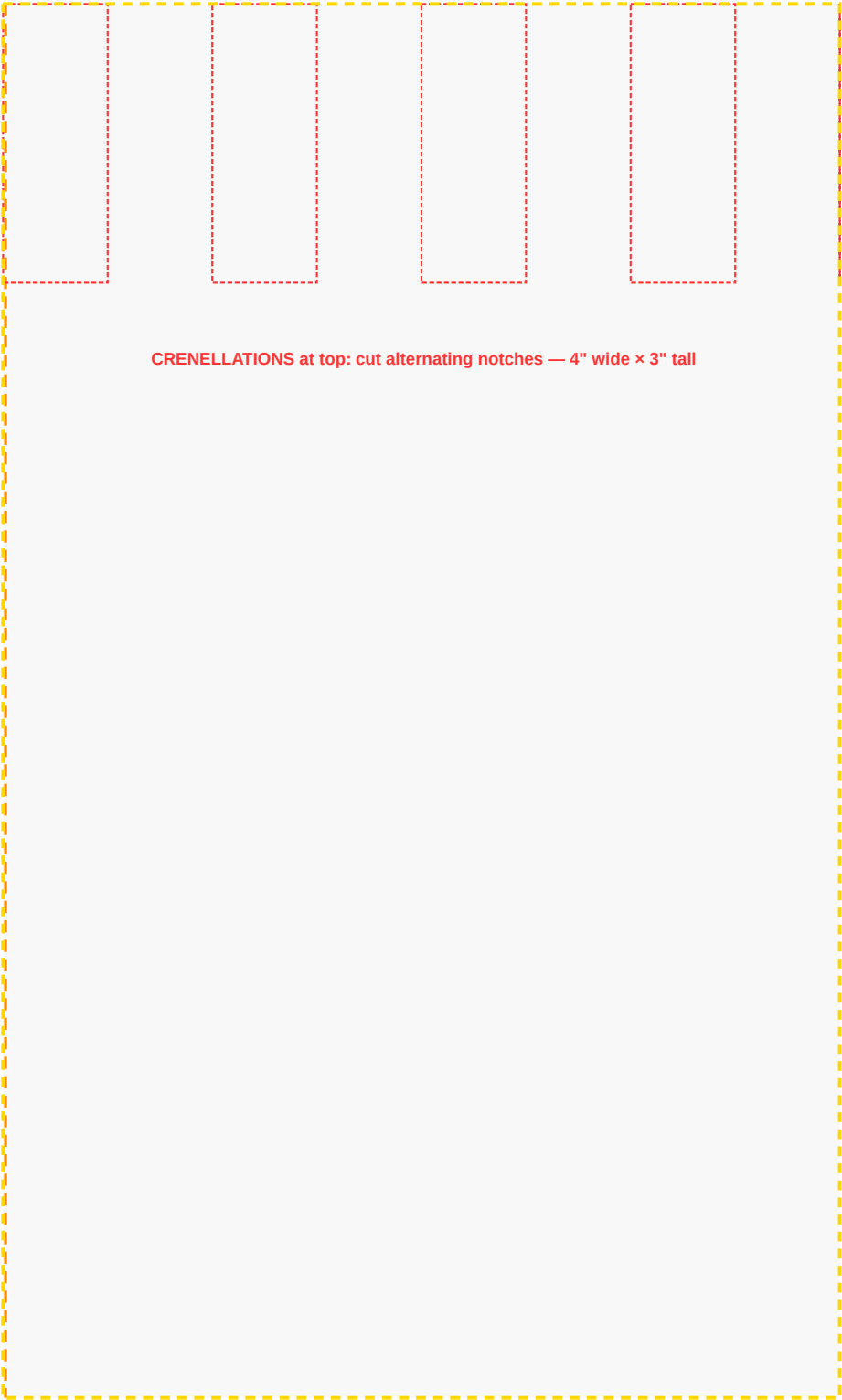
"Build It. Own It." — Tatum & Kash Cardboard Creations



GATEHOUSE TOWER PANEL

18" x 30" (46 x 76 cm) | Cut x4

CUT
x4



CRENELATIONS at top: cut alternating notches — 4" wide x 3" tall

18" x 30" (46 x 76 cm)
2 panels per tower — tape at 90° corner

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

FOLD — score lightly, then fold at this line	NOTCH — cut rectangular slots across this edge
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NOTE: 2 panels per tower — tape at 90° corner



GATEHOUSE ARCH PANEL

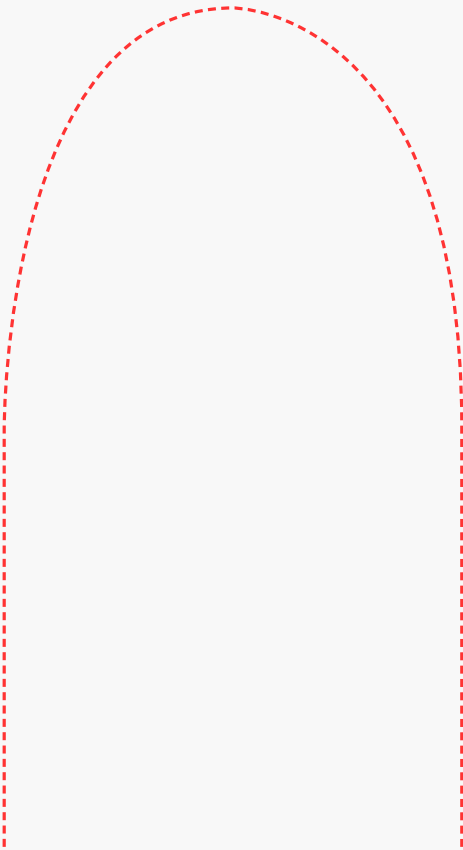
18" x 30" (46 x 76 cm) | Cut x1

CUT
x1

GATEHOUSE ARCH PANEL

x1

CUT ARCH OPENING: centered, tall enough for child to walk through. Keep solid frame all around.
Adult only.



18" x 30" (46 x 76 cm)

Cut arch opening — large enough to walk through

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

ARCH — cut a curved arch opening as shown

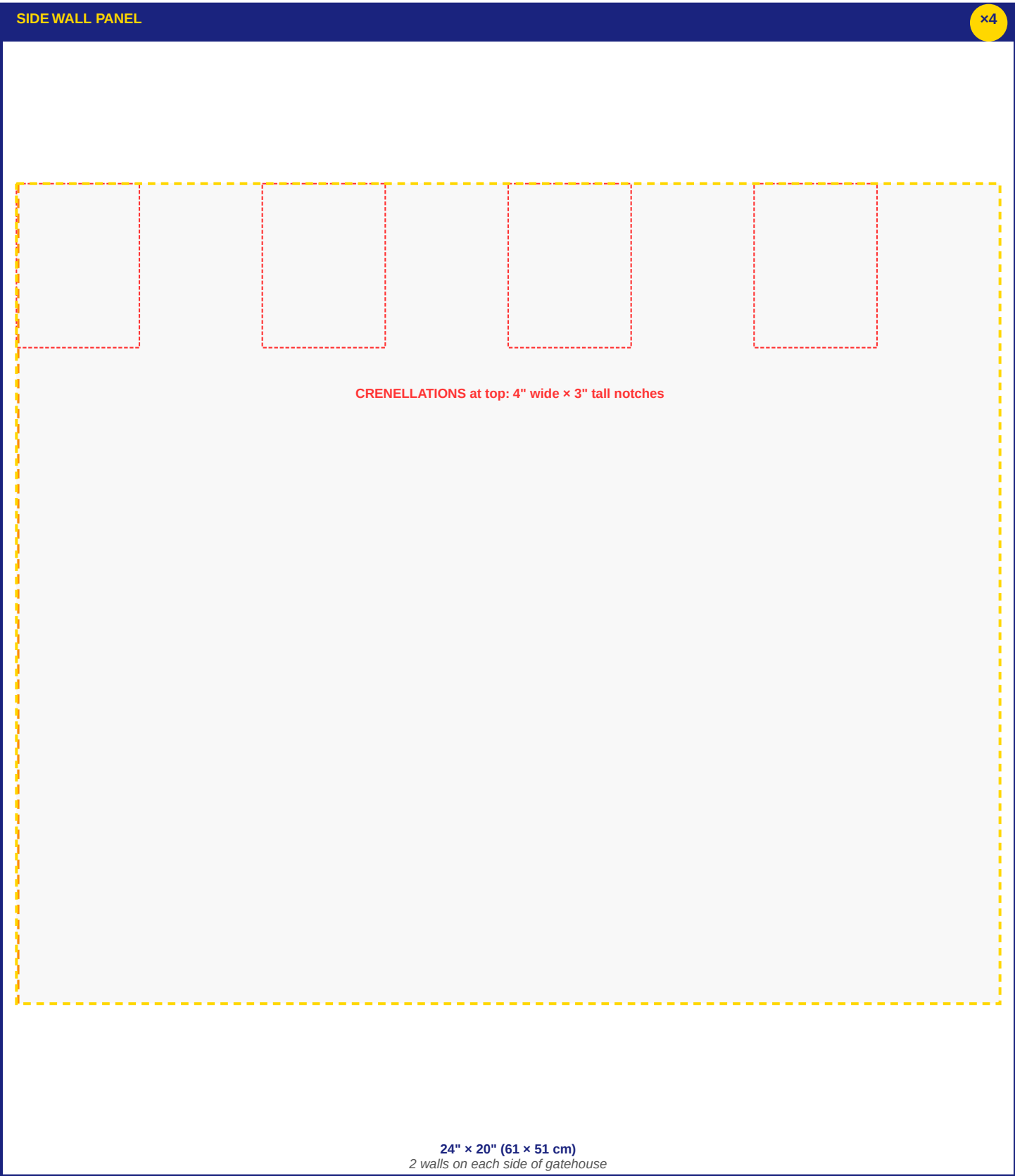
NOTE: Cut arch opening — large enough to walk through



SIDE WALL PANEL

24" x 20" (61 x 51 cm) | Cut x4

CUT
x4



MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

FOLD — score lightly, then fold at this line	NOTCH — cut rectangular slots across this edge
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NOTE: 2 walls on each side of gatehouse

CARDBOARD PIECES — 5 TOTAL (5–7 Large Boxes (at least 24" × 36" (61 × 91 cm) each))



Gatehouse Tower Panel
18" × 30"
2 panels per tower — tape at 90° corner



Gatehouse Arch Panel
18" × 30"
Cut arch opening — large enough to walk through



Side Wall Panel
24" × 20"
2 walls on each side of gatehouse



Corner Tower Panel
12" × 24"
2 panels per corner tower — tape at 90°



Battlement Strip
24" × 8"
Cut alternating notches across top

TOOLS & SUPPLIES

- + 5–7 large cardboard boxes

+ Box cutter — ADULT USE ONLY

+ Packing tape (3+ rolls)
- + GREY PAINT — entire castle is grey stone

+ Black marker for stone block pattern (horizontal + offset vertical lines)

+ Moss green paint for base

FUN FACT!

The oldest castle still standing was built in 963 AD — over 1,000 years ago. Let's see how long yours lasts.

CHALLENGE!

Siege time! One defender inside with foam balls to throw, attackers outside. Castle must survive 3 rounds.

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